MUSIKONG BUMBONG OF ANGONO, RIZAL

Prepared by: DECEMBER RAGRARIO-VALENCIANO

Grade Level: **10**
Area: **Music**

I. OBJECTIVES

A. Content Standards

Demonstrate understanding of the musical characteristics of representative music from the lowlands of Luzon

B. Performance Standards

Perform music of the lowlands (Rizal) with appropriate pitch, rhythm, expression and style

C. Learning Competencies/Objectives

1. Explain the distinguishing characteristics of representative Philippine music selections from Luzon in relation to its culture and geography
2. Sing a song from the lowlands of Luzon
3. Explore ways of producing sounds on a variety of sources that is similar to the instruments being studied

II. CONTENT

Musikong Bumbong of Angono

II. LEARNING RESOURCES

A. References

1. Print Materials

   a. BMI ethnography of Angono's Musikong Bumbong
   b. Pictures of Angono Musikong Bumbong from BMI documentation
   c. Textbook pages
   d. Optional: PowerPoint on History and Geography of Angono, Rizal
   e. Pictures of Higantes of Angono Fiesta
   f. Clear map of Angono, Rizal

2. Audio-Video Materials

   a. BMI interview with Prof. Jose Rommel "Jopat" Gragera, conductor of Angono Wind Ensemble, and Angono Bamboo Instrument Maker
   http://tiny.cc/BMI-Gragera-Interview

   b. BMI documentation of Marcelo H. Del Pilar students playing bumbong at Hiyas ng Bulacan 2020, Malolos, Bulacan
   http://tiny.cc/BMI-Bulacan-MHDP

   c. Music videos from YouTube:

      − Video of Angono Wind Ensemble
      − Video of Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro | Pinoy BK Channel
      − Video of Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro by The Dawn
      − Video on How to Play the Rainstick
      − Video of DIY Rainstick (Fun Kid's Craft)
      − Video of Italian making a rhythmic instrument out of bamboo

3. Music Scores

   "Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro", a folk song of Rizal

B. Other Learning Materials

Available bamboo instruments, i.e., bamboo sticks, rainsticks, triangles, tambourines

IV. PROCEDURE

A. Reviewing the previous lesson or presenting the new lesson

1. Review on Dynamics as an expressive element in music.
2. Show a picture of Higantes.
3. Ask where they are popular and what they are associated with. (Higantes are popular during the fiesta in Angono, Rizal and are said to represent the artistry of Angono).

B. Establishing the purpose of the lesson

This is what we will learn about today:
1. About some information on the music tradition of Angono, Rizal
2. How the speed of a music or song is important in the way the music is performed
3. Singing and interpreting a song composed by a National Artist born in Angono

C. Presenting examples/instances of the new lesson

1. Today, by taking a look at a tradition practiced by our fellow Filipinos in Angono, Rizal, we will recognize values that we Filipinos live by: being community-based, musicianship, and spontaneity.

2. Sing a folksong from Rizal whose composer we do not know as it is a folk song.
3. In groups, create an improvised Rain Stick that we can use when performing the song, together with other available instruments.

D. Discussing new concepts and practicing new skills # 1

1. Discussion on the video on one of Angono's bands performing in a parade during the town fiesta:
   a. In Angono, the fiesta is called Feast of St. Clement, the Patron of Fishermen, celebrated on November 23; The feast is said to have been made more festive and prominent by the wives of fishermen who helped their husbands sell fish to the people of the community. It is said that they would assemble in the patio or church plaza and join the procession to thank God for the blessings and bounty of the sea. These women were called Parehadoras. Their assembly for the procession inspired the attendance of musical bands, higantes, and wet, muddy and dancing people.
   b. The famous higantes or giants composed of a Father, Mother, and Son represents Angono as the Arts Capital of the Philippines, as the saying goes the people of Angono learns to draw and paint before they learn to walk and talk.
   c. Bands play a major role on this festive day where each school or barangay has a band that joins to help fill and keep the joyful mood and high spirit of occasion and for every fiesta occasion, at least 10 bands go marching and playing their music around the town.
   d. The tradition of the famous bands of Angono is said to have started with a group of musicians who played musical instruments made of bamboo because they could not afford to buy those expensive brass instruments. These brass instruments were called Musikong Bumbong or Band instruments made of bamboo. With their strong musicianship, they created their own instruments out of the bamboo that was after all many in Angono. One of its makers was Lieutenant Lauriano Gragera. His instruments no longer exist, but there are a few displayed on the wall of a relative's house and are covered with cling-wrap for protection and posterity. These instruments are now said to be about 60 years old.
2. Using the photos and videos, compare the musikong bumbong instruments from Angono and Bulacan. Discussion:
   a. The instruments seen in the photos and videos such as the bamboo baritone, French horn, and trombone are called Musikong Bumbong instruments which are famous in Bulacan and are in fact still existing and performed.
   b. Since we are talking about music from Angono, there are however no more Musikong Bumbong instruments that still exist save for very few that are displayed in the home of the maker's family.
   c. The difference between the Musikong Bumbong of Bulacan and the Musikong Bumbong of Angono is that those from Angono do not have the woven rattan bells but instead have buzzer endpipes.
3. Present and discuss some excerpts from BMI ethnography of Angono's Musikong Bumbong

4. Creating an improvised rainstick:
   a. Mention that a simple bamboo instrument that we can make is the popular rainstick;
   b. Add that rainsticks are made of bamboo but that looking for a piece of bamboo is difficult, hence homemade materials are used instead for the project.
   c. Watch the following videos:
      - How to Play the Rainstick
      - DIY Rainstick (Fun Kid's Craft)
   d. Present materials needed to make the improvised rainstick:
      - empty thick cardboard roll beans, small nails
      - small hammer
      - packaging tape
      - crayons/ribbons for decoration
   e. Make the improvised rainstick
   f. Practice playing the improvised rainstick in that it produces sounds shown on the video

E. Discussing new concepts and practicing new skills # 2

1. Present song "Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro" via the videos:
   - Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro | Pinoy BK Channel
   - Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro by The Dawn
2. Learn song via Teaching a Song Method:
   a. Listen to whole folk song
   b. Brief discussion on some characteristics of folk songs:
      - talks on social issues;
      - learned through oral tradition;
      - intent of composer is obviously not for profit that is why composer is usually not known
   c. rhythmic reading/syllabication by phrase
   d. l earning the melody by phrase
   e. sing the whole song
   f. practice song in groups employing expressive elements

F. Developing mastery (leads to formative assessment)

In preparation for the assessment of a Creative Performance of "Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro", students will:

1. As a class, watch the video:
   - Italian making a rhythmic instrument out of bamboo:
2. In groups, perform the song "Magtanim Ay 'Di Biro" employing:
   - Proficient rhythm and melody
   - Expressive elements and movement
   - Explore on texture with use of created improvised rain sticks and other available instruments, i.e., bamboo sticks, triangles, tambourines, and some form of application from the video
3. Assessment with teacher-made rubrics

G. Finding practical applications of concept and skills in daily living

Prompt: Since we were able to make homemade rainsticks, what other improvised music instruments can we make out of unused household items to manifest respect for the environment?

H. Making generalization and abstraction about the lesson

Sustaining the Filipinos' tradition of the fiesta is of value not only because it makes us a happier people but also because we become more sensitive and caring for one another as a community.

Filipinos' sense of musicianship includes not only the discipline of learning the techniques of performing the instrument, but also the skill of creating instruments out of the rich environment. More so, Filipinos' sense of musicianship includes the idealism of sharing the talent in fiestas with the community more than just performing on the pedestal of the stage to be revered by a few.

I. Additional activities for application or remediation

Create more improvised music instruments out of unused household items for addition to the texture as well as enjoyment to songs performed.

V. TEACHER'S REMARKS

VI. REFLECTION

A. How many learners earned 80% in the evaluation? How many learners require additional activities for remediation?
B. Did the remedial lesson work? How many learners have caught up with the lesson? How many learners continue to require remediation?
C. Which of my teaching strategies worked well? Why did this work?
D. What difficulties can my principal or supervisor help me solve?
E. What innovation or localized materials did I use/discover which I wish to share with other teachers?

Excerpt from the BMI Ethnography of Angono's Musikong Bumbong
"Musikong Bumbong: Musika Kawayan of Angono, Rizal"
By Juliet R. Bien

DESCRIPTION OF THE INSTRUMENTS

A. French horn

Simulating a brass French horn, the *musikong bumbong* prototype has the following measurements: length 20 inches, width 17 inches, height 3 inches, diameter of biggest barrel 2 inches, and valve 5 inches. It has three valve levers interconnected side by side by a 7-inch bamboo dowel. The "fake" mechanism rests on a lead pipe which coils around the body of the instrument spanning 51 centimeters. From the valves, the coiled pipe passes through a 3-inch bamboo connector with an approximate diameter of 1 inch. The pipe is then attached to the bigger vertical pipe (17 inches length and 3 inches diameter) which is the opening of the instrument. The air column spans the length of the mouthpiece traversing towards the main vertical chamber. The sound mechanism does not include the valves and the coiled pipes. The tone is produced through the transverse pipe towards the vertical chamber. The endpipe is slashed with 7-inch incisions to produce a buzzing sound. The endpipe functions as the bell valve. Unlike the brass French horn and the *musikong bumbong* instruments in other towns like Bulacan, the *bumbong* version of Angono's Musikang Kawayan does not have a bell.

B. Trombone

The trombone prototype is a composite of the main body and its removable slide. Like the other bumbong instruments, the bamboo design is a simulation of a brass trombone. The air is blown through the mouthpiece channeled towards the tip of the instrument, with the slide as decoration. The buzzer takes the place of the bell and the bell valve. The measurements are as follows: length (with unstretched slide) 42 inches, length of removable slide 24 inches, mounting rod for the removable slide 13 inches, total length of removable slide curved pipe 51 inches, removable slide brace 4 inches, length of main body 55 inches, incised buzzer 4 inches, main air chamber 19 inches, and airpipe diameter 1.75 inches.

The sound is produced by blowing the air through a detachable funnel-shaped mouthpiece carved from a piece of wood. The platform supports the main body of the instrument and holds the parallel rods from which the removable slide is mounted. The air column chamber traverses down to the left and curves toward the bell cylinder. The sound passes through a series of bamboo pipes with various lengths: a medium-sized vertical 7-inch chamber, a small U-shaped 8-inch pipe, 0.5 inch connected to a 2-inch medium sized joints, and a 28-inch barrel with a 2-inch diameter.

The removable slide consists of an elongated deep and narrow U-shaped bamboo pipe spanning 55 inches supported by two braces on both ends. The braces consist of a medium sized bamboo cylinder and a smaller pipe which are located closer to the mouthpiece and towards the end of the instrument, respectively. This mechanism is randomly slid and does not produce musical sounds. During performance, the slide is moved randomly as an imitation of how trombones are played in the brass band.

C. Trumpet

The trumpet is a singular piece of instrument with the following measurements: length 22 inches, width 7 inches, height approximately 5 inches, total length when uncoiled 56 inches, thickest diameter 1.25 inches. From the mouthpiece, the lead pipe loops into a curved body which consists of three interconnected bamboo pipes imitating the outline of a brass trumpet. The three parallel 7-inch valves strung together by a bamboo rod is mounted into the loop by two 5-inch braces on the left and right sides with a distance of two inches from the valves.

A narrow bamboo pipe is curved connecting the straight barrels towards the outlet. The largest pipe with a diameter of 1.25 inches takes the place of the bell. Like the other instruments of the set, the endpipe is a cylindrical piece of bamboo and incised towards the end to produce a buzzing sound. Air is simply blown into the mouthpiece and adjusted by the musician's lips according to the repertoire. The valves are randomly played to imitate trumpet-playing in the Western brass band tradition.

D. Euphonium

The largest instrument in the collection, the euphonium consists of two vertical pipes supported by two horizontal braces. The three valves constructed parallel to each other are connected by narrow pipes looping its way towards the lead pipe simulating the design of a brass euphonium. The measurements are as follows: longer vertical pipe right side 29 inches, horizontal beams 13 inches, shorter vertical pipe 14 inches, width 12 inches, length of coiled frame 50 inches, valves 7 inches, finger stop diameter 0.25 inches, and endpipe diameter 3 inches. The euphonium is the only instrument with a finger stop bored through the lower corner of the larger vertical pipe at the opposite side from its player.

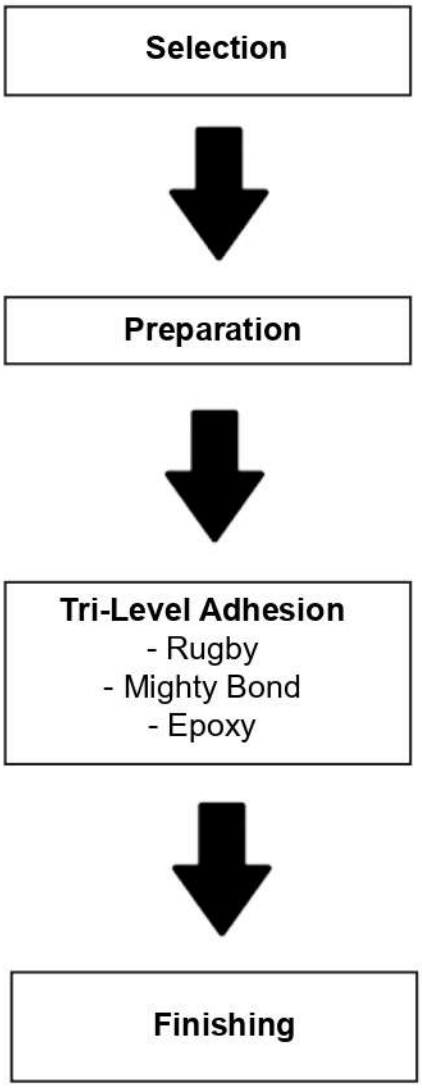
The simulation of its brass counterpart is done by constructing the coiled mechanism on top of the larger pipes functioning as the main frame supporting the valves and the coils. From the mouthpiece, the sound is produced passing through the horizontal beam, then through the curved pipe at its end as it connects to the endpipe. Like the rest of the instruments, the bell is replaced by the endpipe incised with 7-inch slits and produces a buzzing sound. The tones are refined by adjusting the finger stop. The rest of the coiled mechanism and the valves are not functional. Like the rest of the instruments, they are designed to imitate the brass euphonium but do not produce any sound.

The instrument's "aesthetic look" consists of the valves and the coils mounted on the bigger pipes. Between the first and the second valve, a narrow bamboo pipe is curved to form a U-shaped pipe towards the body of the shorter vertical pipe. A bigger U-frame enclosing the valves is constructed approximately two inches on the left side of the first valve whose end is attached to a bigger vertical pipe attached to the smaller vertical supporting pipe frame. A curved enclosure is completed by a U-shaped narrow pipe connected to the lead pipe.

Excerpt from the BMI Ethnography of Bulacan's Musikong Bumbong
"Mr. Rodrigo Anastacio and the Banda Santa Clara Musikong Bumbong of Obando, Bulacan"
By Daniel Ray C. Eramis

PRODUCING THE BAMBOO MUSICAL INSTRUMENTS

Based on the discussion with Sir Rod, the diagram will explain the analyzed systematic process of producing the bamboo musical instruments from selection of materials to the final form of an instrument:



For Sir Rod, the best time to choose bamboo for an instrument is when it is fresh, so as it is easier to cut. He prefers to source his supply from Bulacan, usually from the areas of Plaridel, Pulilan, and Baliwag as it is available all year round within the province. He chooses *buho* (a hollow kind of bamboo) as small tube pieces for regular to small sized instruments and large bamboo species (size of saucer in diameter) for the bigger sized instruments like the *bajo* (tuba/bass).

After selecting, the specific parts of the bamboo are cut to fit the need of an instrument. They are then prepared by sanding out unnecessary parts and treating the insides with varnish to avoid weevil infestation.

Soon after the treatment had dried up, the bamboo parts are structured together and undergo three layers of adhesives:

1) Initially, the parts – inclusive of auxiliary parts – are joined with Rugby.
2) Once dried, the structure is reinforced with Mighty Bond. Sometimes small bamboo sheets or sticks are used to strengthen specific spots.
3) The joints are covered with Epoxy to fully strengthen the structure.

After the Epoxy has dried up, the excess is sanded off to provide aesthetic look for the finished instrument. Sometimes, if deemed necessary, certain areas are given another layer of adhesive. Once done, the whole instrument is protected with a layer of varnish.

For instrument making process and design patent concerns, the table below describes the innovative technique/s that Sir Rod had applied in his craft:

<table>
<tr><th colspan="2">Instrument</th><th>General
Bumbong Instruments</th><th>Folk
Obando – Banda Santa Clara</th><th>Individual
Sir Rod</th></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Pitched</td><td>Flute (Recorder)</td><td>Made of bamboo</td><td>-</td><td>-</td></tr>
<tr><td>Saxophone</td><td rowspan="9">Originally, all instruments were made of straight bamboo cuts, having varying sizes and lengths depending on the desired role.</td><td>Took shape with the use of cara-bao horn as reed, and tin can as resonator.</td><td rowspan="9">The most unique methods that Sir Rod utilized in producing the instruments are as follows:
1) Use of varnish to protect instruments from infestation.
2) Use of the trilevel adhesion method (rug-by, mighty bond, and epoxy).
3) Use of rattan for the bells of specific instruments using them.</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="6">Buzz</td><td>Flute</td><td rowspan="6">Instruments be-gan taking shape similar to their brass band counterparts with use of kazoo as primary producer of sound.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Transverse Flute</td></tr>
<tr><td>Trumpet</td></tr>
<tr><td>Clarinet</td></tr>
<tr><td>Baritone</td></tr>
<tr><td>Trombone</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Single-Pitched</td><td>French Horn</td><td rowspan="2">Like all instru-ments in the ensemble, took shape into their brass band coun-terparts with the spit type sound production.</td></tr>
<tr><td>Bajo (Tuba)</td></tr>
</table>

Aside from the innovations presented in the table above, some notable features of the bamboo musical instruments of Banda Santa Clara are the keys attached in the instruments like those in French Horns which do not really have any function but as accessories for performative purposes. They are made of button-shaped plastic attached to spring mechanisms to make them realistically look like their counterparts.

THE INSTRUMENTS AND THEIR ROLES

The ensemble of Banda Santa Clara Musikong Bumbong can be categorized under three methods of sound production: 1) Pitched Instruments, 2) Spit-type (like in brass instruments), and 3) Kazoo-based or Buzz Membrane. Due to the limitations of majority of the instruments, they play songs that are usually in or are transposed to the key of C Major. The table below helps to explain the methods of sound production, range, and role of each instrument in the ensemble.

<table>
<tr><th colspan="2">Instrument</th><th>Method of Sound Production</th><th>Melodic Range</th><th>Role in the Ensemble</th></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Pitched</td><td>Flute (Recorder)</td><td>- A kiss-flute method where a reed is fixed on the instrument
- Pitch is manipulated by covering holes</td><td>c1 to c3 (2 octaves) but can be higher if advanced</td><td>Lead Voice</td></tr>
<tr><td>Saxophone</td><td>- Using the carabao horn as reed and tin can as resonator
- Pitch of the sound produced is manipulated by covering holes.</td><td>c1 to c3 (2 octaves) but can be higher if advanced</td><td>Lead Voice</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="5">Buzz Membrane</td><td>Trumpet</td><td rowspan="5">- Sound is produced by speaking through the mouthpiece which cause the membrane to buzz.
- The pitch of the sound produced is based on the performers singing.</td><td rowspan="5">Range depends on the performer. Instrument can make clear sound from a to a2</td><td>Lead / 2nd Voice</td></tr>
<tr><td>Flute & Transverse Flute</td><td>Lead / 2nd Voice</td></tr>
<tr><td>Clarinet</td><td>2nd Voice</td></tr>
<tr><td>Baritone</td><td>2nd / 3rd Voice</td></tr>
<tr><td>Trombone</td><td>2nd / 3rd Voice</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="2">Single-Pitched</td><td>French Horn</td><td rowspan="2">Similar to brass instruments,
The pressure of air affects resultant pitch</td><td>Between G to A (Overtone Possible)</td><td>Ostinato Response to Bass</td></tr>
<tr><td>Bajo (Tuba)</td><td>Between C to D (Overtone Possible)</td><td>Down Beat Keepe</td></tr>
<tr><td rowspan="3">Percussion</td><td>Cymbals</td><td>Clashing (Metal)</td><td>-</td><td>For Emphasis Parts</td></tr>
<tr><td>Snare Drum</td><td>Membrane and Rim Striking</td><td>-</td><td rowspan="2">Time Keeper, Signals the Band</td></tr>
<tr><td>Bass Drum</td><td>Membrane Striking</td><td>-</td></tr>
</table>